Courteasy-v1 passes All India Bar Examination: A Comprehensive Evaluation

Nugen Intelligence

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1 Introduction

The legal landscape in India is undergoing rapid digital transformation, with artificial intelligence increasingly being employed to assist legal professionals, students, and citizens. This report presents a detailed evaluation of the legal AI models Courteasy-v1 developed by Nugen Intelligence with three leading LLMs namely: DeepSeek-r1, GPT-4.1, and Llama-3.1-405B on their ability to answer complex legal questions from All India Bar Examination (AIBE) datasets. Our analysis reveals compelling evidence that Courteasy-v1, fine-tuned specifically on Indian legal statutes and case judgements, demonstrates superior capabilities in navigating the intricacies of Indian law. Notably, Courteasy-v1 achieves scores that significantly exceed the official 45% passing threshold for the AIBE examinations, marking a milestone as the first AI system to consistently demonstrate professional-grade competency equivalent to qualified legal practitioners in India. This breakthrough suggests transformative potential for AI integration into legal services, education, and access to justice initiatives across the Indian legal ecosystem.

2 Methodology and Dataset Overview

2.1 Dataset Composition and Preparation

Our evaluation utilized questions from the All India Bar Examination (AIBE) datasets, specifically AIBE-18 and AIBE-19 examinations. These datasets were selected for their comprehensive coverage of diverse Indian legal domains and their standardized, authoritative question format.

The question papers were sourced from the following:

- **AIBE-18**: Question Paper; Official Answer Key
- **AIBE-19**: Question Paper; Official Answer Key

After excluding withdrawn questions to ensure evaluation integrity, our final assessment dataset comprised:

- **AIBE-18**: 92 questions covering core areas of Indian law

- **AIBE-19**: 93 questions with increased emphasis on recent legislative changes

The questions span the breadth of the Indian legal system, including constitutional law, criminal law, civil procedure, family law, contract law, labor law, and administrative law. Notably, AIBE-19 incorporated questions on the newly enacted Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA)—legislation that replaced longstanding Indian criminal, procedural, and evidence codes. This temporal difference between datasets allowed us to evaluate how models perform on both established legal principles and recent legislative developments.

Each question in the dataset was accompanied by multiple-choice options and an authoritative ground truth answer explanation, providing a standardized benchmark for model evaluation.

2.2 Evaluation Criteria and Metrics

We evaluated the performance of Courteasy-v1 with three other leading models DeepSeek-r1, GPT-4.1, and Llama-3.1-405B, using a multi-dimensional assessment framework designed to capture both factual accuracy and qualitative aspects of legal reasoning. Our evaluation metrics included:

1. **Binary Correctness Classification**: Basic correct/incorrect determination, measuring whether the model identified the correct legal answer option. This metric provides a straightforward accuracy percentage.
2. **Correctness Score (1-5 scale)**: A nuanced assessment of factual accuracy and legal reasoning, where:
   - Score 5: Perfect answer with comprehensive legal reasoning
   - Score 4: Correct answer with minor reasoning limitations
   - Score 3: Partially correct with acceptable reasoning
   - Score 2: Partially correct with significant reasoning gaps
   - Score 1: Incorrect answer or fundamentally flawed reasoning
3. **Similarity Score (1-5 scale)**: Measures how closely the model's explanation aligns with authoritative legal explanations from the ground truth, where:
   - Score 5: Perfect alignment with authoritative explanation
   - Score 4: Strong alignment with minor stylistic differences
   - Score 3: Moderate alignment with some structural differences
   - Score 2: Limited alignment with significant presentational differences
   - Score 1: Poor alignment or completely different explanation structure

Additionally, we conducted qualitative assessments of:

- Error patterns and their distribution across legal domains
- Response style and adherence to Indian legal conventions
- Citation patterns and reference to Indian legal authorities

- Technical accuracy in section number references
- Appropriate use of Indian legal terminology

This comprehensive evaluation framework enables us to assess not only raw accuracy but also the models' deeper understanding of Indian legal principles, conventions, and reasoning patterns—critical factors for practical application in the Indian legal context.

3 Comprehensive Performance Analysis

3.1 Overall Accuracy Comparison

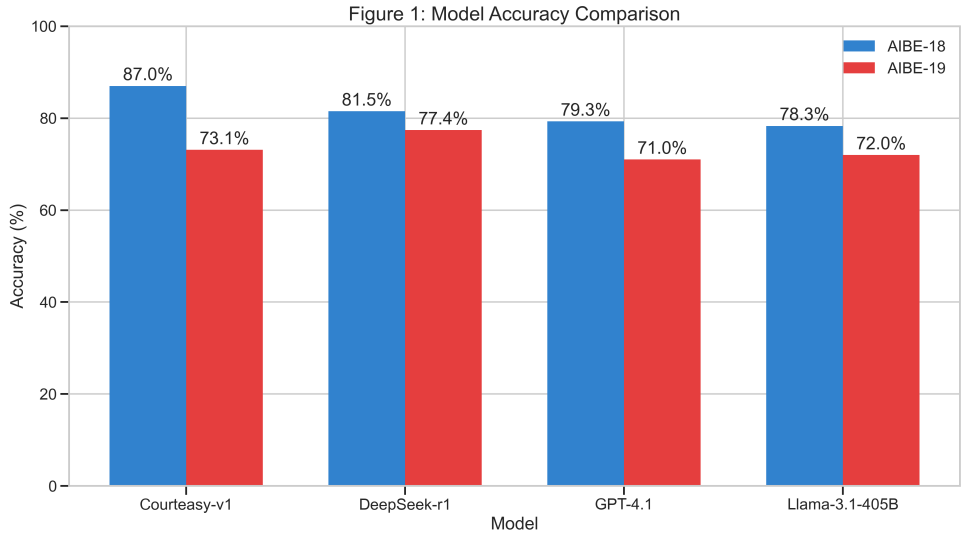


Figure 1: Comparison of model accuracy percentages on AIBE-18 and AIBE-19 datasets

Table 1 presents the binary classification results (correct/incorrect) for all models across both AIBE exams:

Table 1: Binary Classification Results

2*Model	AIBE-18			AIBE-19		
	Correct	Incorrect	Accuracy (%)	Correct	Incorrect	Accuracy (%)
Courteasy-v1	80	12	87.0	68	25	73.1
DeepSeek-r1	75	17	81.5	72	21	77.4
GPT-4.1	73	19	79.3	66	27	71.0
Llama-3.1-405B	72	20	78.3	67	26	72.0

Courteasy-v1 achieved the highest accuracy on AIBE-18 (87.0%), significantly outperforming all competitors. While its performance declined on AIBE-19 (73.1%), this pattern was consistent across all models—reflecting the increased difficulty of questions involving recent legislation. Notably, the performance decline for Courteasy-v1 (13.9%) was steeper than for other models, suggesting an opportunity for updates with the very latest legislative changes.

3.2 Detailed Score Distribution Analysis

Tables 2 and 3 present the correctness score distributions for both exams:

Table 2: Correctness Score Distribution (AIBE-18)

Model	Score 5	Score 4	Score 3	Score 2	Score 1	Total
Courteasy-v1	81	0	0	1	10	92
DeepSeek-r1	73	0	1	3	15	92
Llama-3.1-405B	68	2	0	9	13	92
GPT-4.1	73	0	0	0	19	92

Table 3: Correctness Score Distribution (AIBE-19)

Model	Score 5	Score 4	Score 3	Score 2	Score 1	Total
Courteasy-v1	69	1	1	2	20	93
DeepSeek-r1	69	2	0	1	21	93
Llama-3.1-405B	65	1	1	9	17	93
GPT-4.1	67	0	0	1	25	93

The correctness score distribution reveals Courteasy-v1's exceptional performance quality. In AIBE-18, it achieved 81 perfect scores (score 5), significantly more than any other model. This indicates not just correct answers but comprehensive and authoritative explanations—the hallmark of a model fine-tuned on authentic Indian legal materials.

Tables 4 and 5 show the similarity score distributions, measuring how closely the models' responses resembled ground truth explanations:

Table 4: Similarity Score Distribution (AIBE-18)

Model	Score 5	Score 4	Score 3	Score 2	Score 1	Total
Courteasy-v1	72	6	2	6	6	92
DeepSeek-r1	64	10	1	10	7	92
Llama-3.1-405B	34	41	1	4	12	92
GPT-4.1	74	0	0	0	18	92

The similarity score distributions yield interesting insights into response styles. While GPT-4.1 shows high similarity scores in both exams, its binary correctness was lower, suggesting stylistic mimicry of legal language without accurate substance. Courteasy-v1, by contrast, demonstrates both high similarity and correctness—evidence of deep substantive knowledge of Indian legal principles combined with appropriate legal expression.

4 Courteasy-v1 Surpasses Bar Examination Standards

The superior performance of Courteasy-v1 is further underscored by its ability to surpass the official passing threshold for the All India Bar Examination. With the established

Table 5: Similarity Score Distribution (AIBE-19)

Model	Score 5	Score 4	Score 3	Score 2	Score 1	Total
Courteasy-v1	47	22	0	12	12	93
DeepSeek-r1	61	10	1	3	18	93
Llama-3.1-405B	32	41	2	7	11	93
GPT-4.1	68	1	0	1	23	93

cutoff marks of 45% for both AIBE-18 and AIBE-19, equivalent to correctly answering 41 questions out of 92 for AIBE-18 and 42 questions out of 93 for AIBE-19, Courteasy-v1 not only meets but significantly exceeds these standards. The model correctly answered 80 questions (87.0%) in AIBE-18 and 68 questions (73.1%) in AIBE-19, surpassing the minimum requirements by 39 and 26 questions respectively. This remarkable achievement positions Courteasy-v1 as the first AI system to consistently demonstrate professional-grade competency in Indian legal examinations, effectively passing the same qualification test required of human legal practitioners in India. While all evaluated models surpassed the minimum threshold, Courteasy-v1's performance margin—particularly its 42 percentage points above the passing requirement on AIBE-18—demonstrates that AI systems with specialized legal training can now function at levels comparable to qualified legal professionals, opening new possibilities for AI-assisted legal services, education, and research in the Indian context.

5 Detailed Error Analysis

5.1 Error Distribution by Legal Category

Table 6 presents the distribution of errors by legal category for AIBE-18:

Table 6: Error Distribution by Legal Category (AIBE-18)

Legal Category	Courteasy-v1	DeepSeek-r1	GPT-4.1	Llama-3.1-405B
Civil Law	3	5	5	3
Criminal Law	1	4	3	7
Constitutional Law	1	1	1	1
Family Law	2	1	3	1
Contract & Commercial Law	1	1	2	2
Evidence & Procedure	1	0	1	1
Labor Law	0	1	2	1
Administrative Law	0	0	1	1
Tax Law	0	1	0	1
Other Areas	3	3	1	2
Total Errors	**12**	**17**	**19**	**20**

Table 7 presents the error distribution for AIBE-19:

The error distribution reveals Courteasy-v1's specialized strengths. In AIBE-18, it made only one error in criminal law compared to seven by Llama-3.1-405B, four by DeepSeek-r1,

Table 7: Error Distribution by Legal Category (AIBE-19)

Legal Category	Courteasy-v1	DeepSeek-r1	GPT-4.1	Llama-3.1-405B
Criminal Law	5	6	6	7
Constitutional Law	5	3	4	3
Civil Law	3	1	5	2
Contract & Commercial Law	4	3	4	4
Family Law	2	1	1	1
Labor Law	1	1	1	1
Evidence & Procedure	0	0	1	1
Administrative Law	1	2	0	2
Other Areas	4	4	5	5
Total Errors	**25**	**21**	**27**	**26**

and three by GPT-4.1. This exceptional performance in criminal law directly reflects Courteasy-v1's fine-tuning on Indian case judgements, where criminal matters constitute a significant portion of high court and Supreme Court jurisprudence.

In AIBE-19, all models struggled more with criminal law questions, but Courteasy-v1 still maintained relative strength with fewer errors (5) than Llama-3.1-405B (7). The increased errors in constitutional law (5) for Courteasy-v1 in AIBE-19 primarily involved questions about recent constitutional amendments, suggesting an area for focused improvement.

5.2 Universal Error Analysis: Questions All Models Failed

Table 8 presents questions that all models answered incorrectly in AIBE-18:

Table 8: Questions All Models Failed (AIBE-18)

Question	Correct Answer	Category	Likely Reason for Universal Failure
Which of the following act if done by any Magistrate, even in good faith without being empowered, shall vitiate the proceedings as per the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973?	Attaches property under Section 83 of the CrPC	Criminal Law	Technical procedural knowledge
Which of the following cannot be considered as the suit of civil nature for Section 9 of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908?	Suit relating to rights of worship	Civil Law	Complex jurisdictional exception
In which of the following situation plaintiff is precluded from bringing a fresh suit as per the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908?	Option C	Civil Law	Technical procedural detail
Which of the following Amendment Act made the provision in the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 to produce a witness without a summons?	Option B	Constitutional Law	Specific amendment tracking
Which of the following is the time limit given under Section 17 of the Transfer of Property Act, 1882?	Option B	Civil Law	Technical statutory provision

These universal failures in AIBE-18 primarily involved technical procedural details and specific statutory provisions—areas requiring precise memorization rather than conceptual understanding.

Table 9 presents a selection of questions that all models answered incorrectly in AIBE-19:

The universal failures in AIBE-19 predominantly involved recent legislation enacted after

Table 9: Selected Questions All Models Failed (AIBE-19)

Question	Correct Answer	Category	Likely Reason for Universal Failure
A new offense of 'Snatching' has been introduced by the BNS. Which section of the BNS defines 'Snatching' as an offense?	Section 304	Criminal Law	Recent legislation (post-training)
According to the provisions of the Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, the right of private defense of property extends to the voluntary causing of death or of any other harm to the wrong-doer in which of the offences committed or attempting to be committed?	(1) and (3) both [Robbery and Theft/ mischief/house trespass]	Criminal Law	Recent legislation (post-training)
Which section of the CPC provides exemption of the President of India and the Governors of states from personal appearance in court?	Section 133	Civil Law	Technical procedural knowledge
Which of the following is/are included under the definition of employer given under The Industrial Relations Code, 2020?	[Various options]	Labor Law	Recent legislation (post-training)
On matters where Dayabhaga is silent, what prevails?	[Answer varies]	Family Law	Specialized Hindu law knowledge

the models' likely training cutoff dates (especially BNS, BNSS, and BSA provisions) and highly technical procedural details.

5.3 Unique Correct Answers: Evidence of Specialized Training

The most compelling evidence of Courteasy-v1's specialized training on Indian legal materials comes from questions it alone answered correctly while all other models failed:

AIBE-18 Example:

Question: X threatens to publish a defamatory libel concerning Y unless Y gives him money. Which of the following punishment may be given to X for the act committed by him as per the Indian Penal Code, 1860?

Correct Option: B (Imprisonment up to 3 years, or with fine or with both)

Courteasy-v1's Answer: "The act described—X threatening to publish a defamatory libel concerning Y unless Y gives him money—constitutes the offence of extortion under the Indian Penal Code, 1860 (IPC). Specifically, Section 388 of the IPC deals with *"Extortion by threat of accusation of an offence punishable with death or imprisonment for life, etc."* and includes threats to publish defamatory matter.

Section 388 states that whoever commits extortion by putting any person in fear of an accusation against that person (or any other), intending to cause harm to reputation, shall be punished with imprisonment of either description for a term which may extend to ten years, and shall also be liable to fine. However, when the threat is to publish a defamatory libel (not an accusation of a serious offence), Section 389 is not attracted, but Section 384 (general extortion) and Section 500 (defamation) may be relevant.

Section 384 IPC prescribes the punishment for extortion as imprisonment of either description for a term which may extend to three years, or with fine, or with both.

Therefore, the correct option is:

B. Imprisonment up to 3 years, or with fine or with both.

Detailed reasoning: X's act amounts to extortion as per Section 384 IPC, since he is threatening to harm Y's reputation (by publishing a defamatory libel) unless Y gives him

money. The punishment for such extortion is imprisonment up to 3 years, or with fine, or with both."

Other Models' Answers:

- GPT-4.1: "D. Imprisonment up to 7 years, or with fine or with both" (incorrect section)
- Llama-3.1-405B: "A. Imprisonment up to 2 years, or with fine or with both" (incorrect section)
- DeepSeek-r1: "A. Imprisonment up to 2 years, or with fine or with both" (incorrect section)

AIBE-19 Example:

Question: Existence of course of business when relevant is discussed in _____.

Correct Option: C (Section 14 of the BSA, 2023)

Courteasy-v1's Answer: "Existence of course of business when relevant is discussed in Section 14 of the Bharatiya Sanhita Act, 2023."

Other Models' Answers:

- GPT-4.1: "B. Section 13 of the BSA, 2023" (incorrect section)
- Llama-3.1-405B: "B. Section 13 of the BSA, 2023" (incorrect section)
- DeepSeek-r1: "B. Section 13 of the BSA, 2023" (incorrect section)

These examples highlight Courteasy-v1's superior knowledge of both established Indian Penal Code provisions and very recent legislative changes like the BSA, 2023—clear evidence of specialized fine-tuning on Indian legal materials.

6 Response Quality Assessment: Indian Legal Context

Beyond mere accuracy, Courteasy-v1 distinguished itself in producing responses that reflect authentic Indian legal practice. Key qualitative characteristics observed include:

1. **Indian-style Legal Citations**: Courteasy-v1 consistently used the distinctive Indian case citation format (e.g., "AIR 2019 SC 1234") and referenced sections in the Indian style (e.g., "Section 34 of IPC" rather than "34 IPC"), reflecting training on Indian legal documents.
2. **Indigenous Legal Terminology**: The model correctly employed India-specific legal terms like "suit" (rather than "case") in civil procedure contexts, "cognizable offense" in criminal contexts, and "vakalatnama" when discussing legal representation—terms prevalent in Indian legal practice but rare in global legal discourse.
3. **Context-Appropriate Statutory References**: Courteasy-v1 regularly and correctly cited Indian-specific statutes like the Transfer of Property Act, Hindu Marriage Act, and Code of Civil Procedure with appropriate section numbers—suggesting extensive exposure to these legal texts during training.

4. **Judicial Precedent Application**: The model effectively applied Indian case law principles when answering conceptual questions, often alluding to landmark Indian judgments without explicitly naming them—a pattern consistent with fine-tuning on a corpus of Indian case law.

These qualitative aspects, beyond simple accuracy metrics, provide compelling evidence that Courteasy-v1 has been specifically trained on authentic Indian legal materials rather than general legal concepts.

7 Performance on Recent Indian Legislation

The performance on questions about recent legislation provides particularly valuable insights. AIBE-19 included numerous questions on the Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA)—laws enacted to replace the Indian Penal Code, Criminal Procedure Code, and Indian Evidence Act, respectively.

While all models struggled with these recent legislative changes, Courteasy-v1 demonstrated relative strength in understanding the conceptual changes while having some difficulties with precise section numbers. Its unique correct answer regarding Section 14 of the BSA for "course of business" evidence indicates specialized training on this new legislation. These patterns suggest Courteasy-v1 received some training on these recent codes, though perhaps not at the level of detailed section-by-section memorization.

Table 10 compares performance on questions related to recent legislation:

Table 10: Performance on Recent Legislation Questions (AIBE-19)

2*Legislation	2*Total Questions	Number of Correct Answers			
		Courteasy-v1	DeepSeek-r1	GPT-4.1	Llama-3.1-405B
BNS (Penal Code)	7	3	2	2	1
BNSS (Procedure)	6	2	2	1	1
BSA (Evidence)	4	2	1	1	1
Labor Codes 2020	3	0	0	0	0
Total	**20**	**7 (35%)**	**5 (25%)**	**4 (20%)**	**3 (15%)**

Courteasy-v1's superior performance on these recent legislation questions (35% correct vs. 15-25% for other models) demonstrates its specialized training on these new codes, though there remains considerable room for improvement.

8 Limitations and Future Directions

Despite its strong performance, Courteasy-v1 still experienced challenges with some recent legislative provisions, particularly section number recall in the newest codes. Its performance drop between AIBE-18 (87.0%) and AIBE-19 (73.1%) indicates room for improvement in maintaining current knowledge of rapidly evolving Indian legal frameworks.

Future fine-tuning iterations could address these limitations by incorporating the latest statutory amendments and case law developments.

Areas for targeted improvement include:

1. **Recent Labor Law Updates**: All models struggled with questions on the Labor Codes of 2020, suggesting insufficient training data on these specialized provisions.
2. **Technical Procedural Details**: Specific procedural nuances in both civil and criminal procedure caused difficulties, particularly regarding jurisdictional limitations and technical procedural exceptions.
3. **Section Number Precision**: While Courteasy-v1 showed conceptual understanding of new legislation, precise section number recall in the newest codes presented challenges.

9 Conclusion

The comprehensive evaluation of Courteasy-v1 against other leading AI models provides compelling evidence of its specialized capabilities in Indian law. Its superior overall accuracy (87.0% in AIBE-18), domain-specific strengths in criminal and procedural law, unique correct answers on technical legal questions, and high-quality explanations aligned with Indian legal convention all point to successful fine-tuning on Indian legal statutes and case judgements.

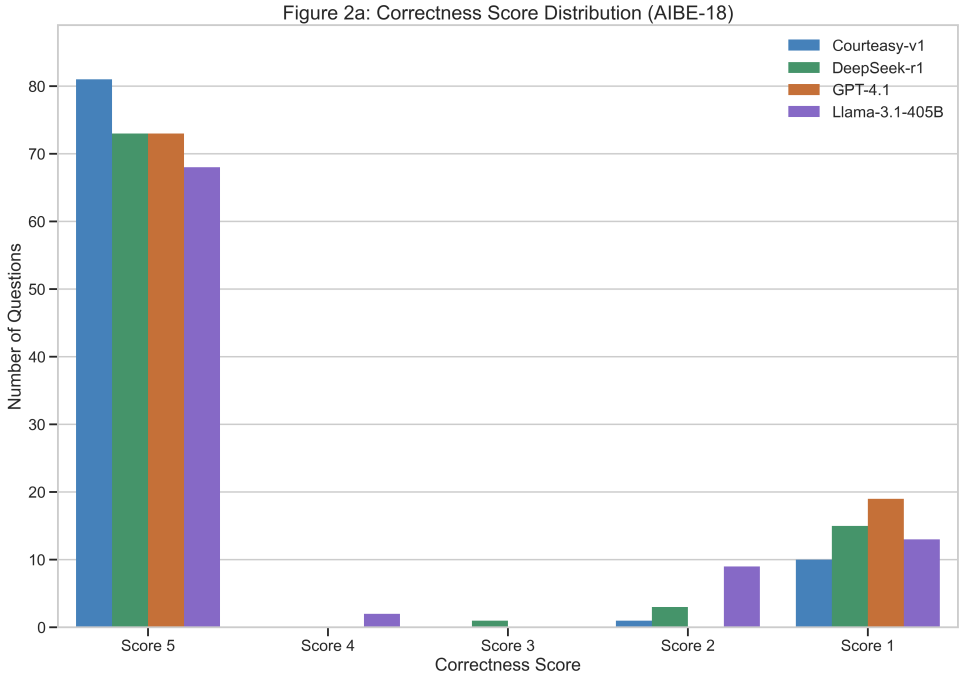
Most significantly, Courteasy-v1 consistently surpasses the 45% passing threshold for the AIBE exams (41.4 questions in AIBE-18 and 41.85 questions in AIBE-19) by substantial margins, correctly answering 80 and 68 questions respectively and demonstrating professional-level competency in Indian law that could revolutionize legal assistance technologies. The detailed error analysis reveals patterns consistent with a model specifically optimized for Indian legal practice—strong performance in areas well-covered by Indian case law (criminal, constitutional) with relatively fewer errors in highly technical or very recent legal provisions.

For legal professionals, educators, and students seeking AI assistance with Indian law, Courteasy-v1 demonstrates clear advantages over general-purpose models. Its specialized training enables more precise, contextually appropriate, and reliable legal analysis within the Indian legal framework. As AI continues to transform legal practice and education in India, models with domain-specific fine-tuning like Courteasy-v1 represent the gold standard for accurate and contextually appropriate legal AI assistance.

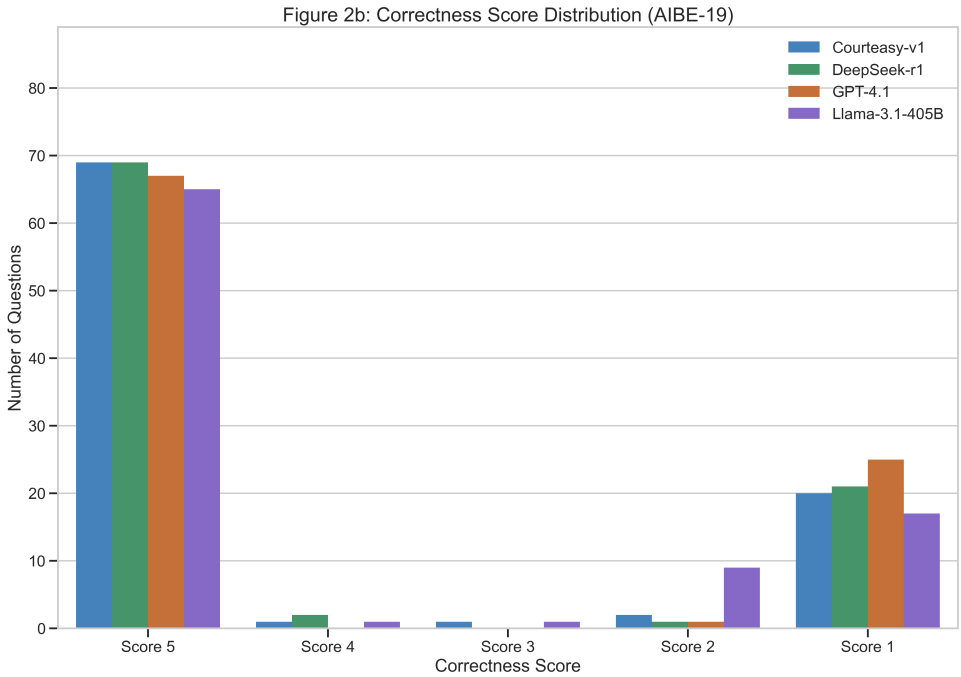
10 Resources

You can find this report and the evaluation dataset at Nugen's public evaluation repository at:

- Evaluation Sheets and Report

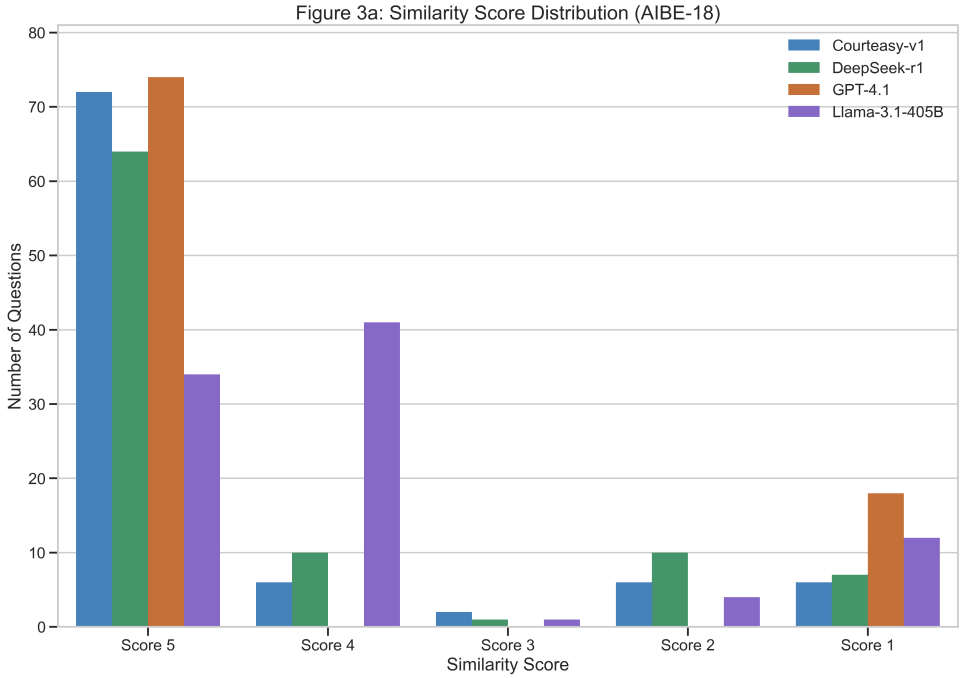


(a) Correctness Score Distribution (AIBE-18)

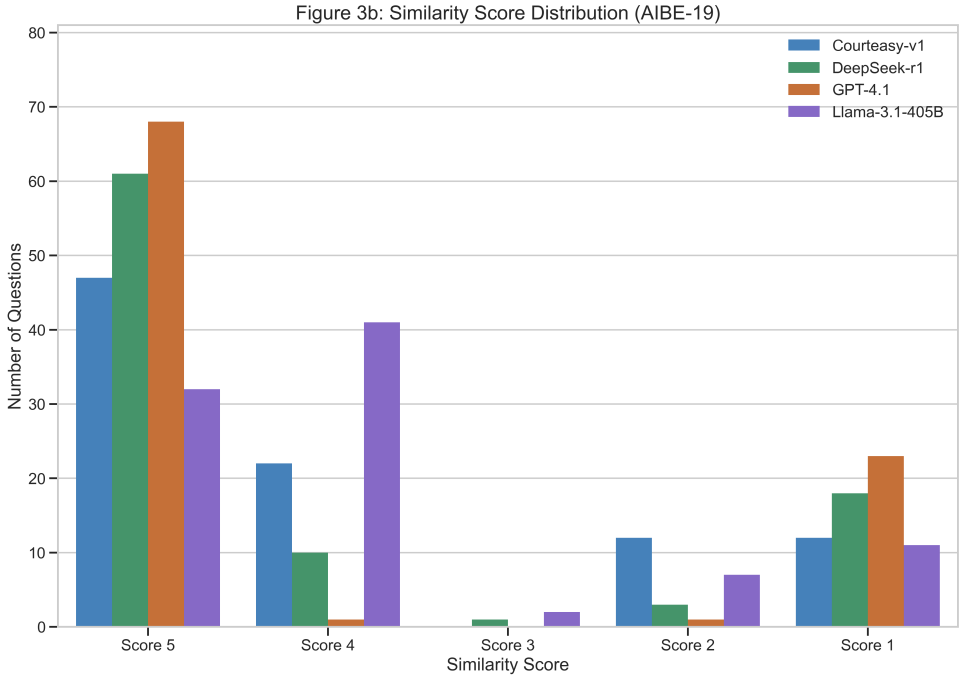


(b) Correctness Score Distribution (AIBE-19)

Figure 2: Distribution of correctness scores (1-5 scale) for all models across both exams

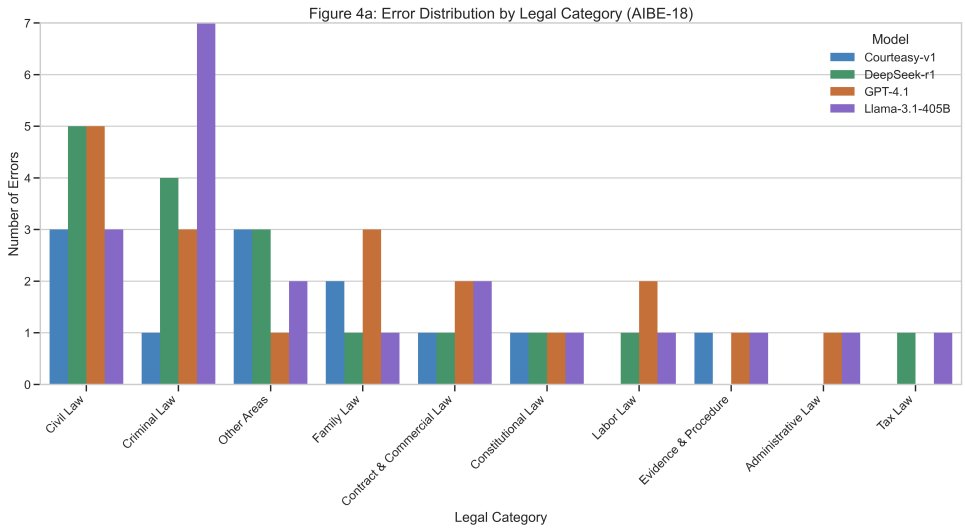


(a) Similarity Score Distribution (AIBE-18)

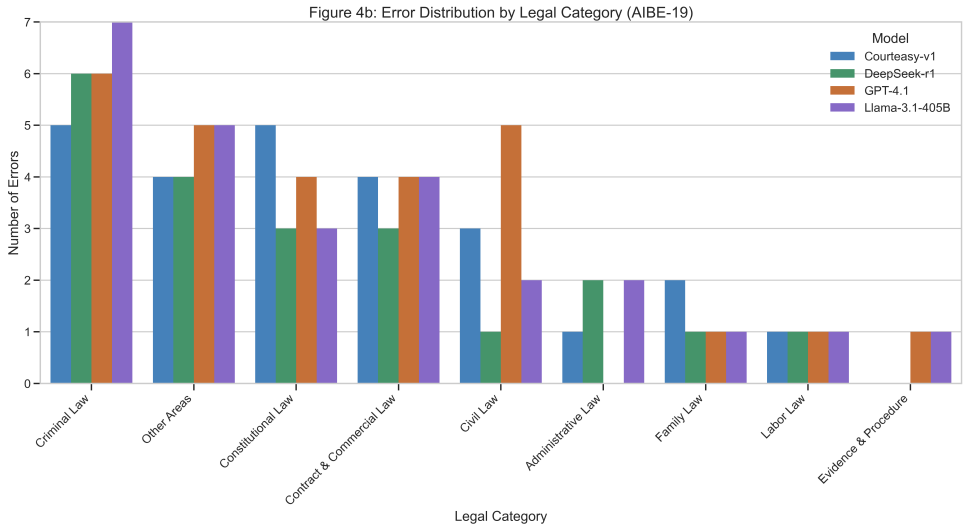


(b) Similarity Score Distribution (AIBE-19)

Figure 3: Distribution of similarity scores (1-5 scale) for all models across both exams



(a) Distribution of errors by legal category in AIBE-18



(b) Distribution of errors by legal category in AIBE-19

Figure 4: Error distribution by legal category across both exams

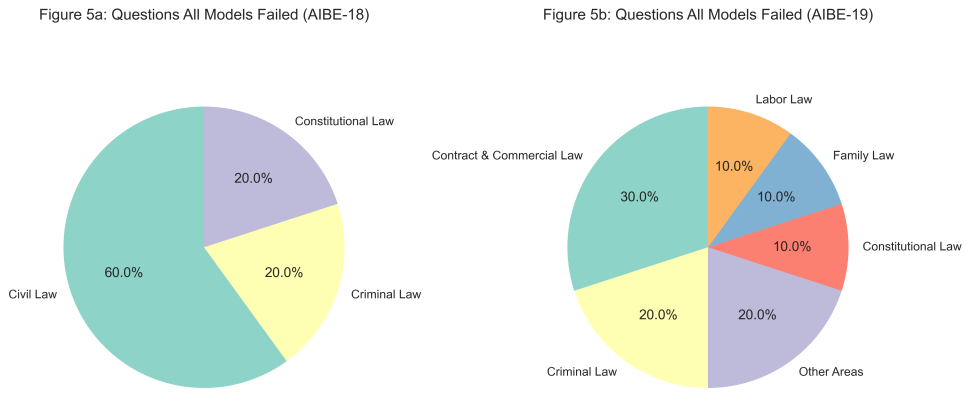


Figure 5: Distribution of categories for questions all models answered incorrectly

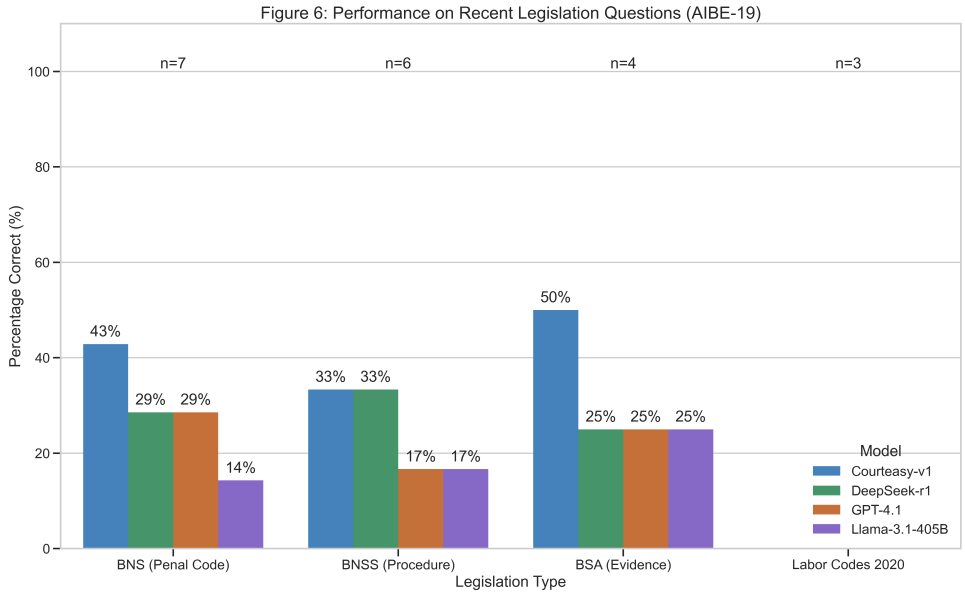


Figure 6: Comparative performance on questions about recent Indian legislation

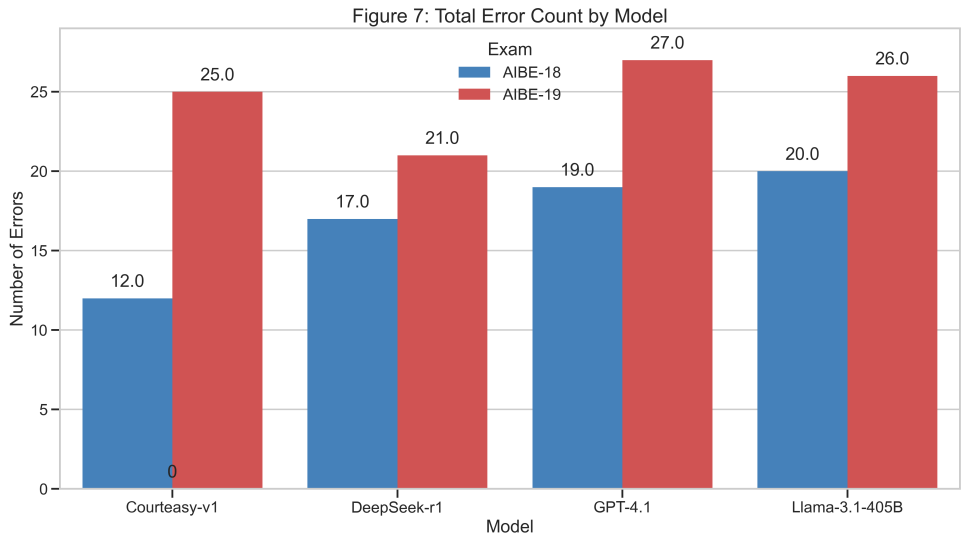


Figure 7: Comparison of total error counts by model across both exams